

Looking to Buy a Low-Cost Laptop? Chromebook could be a Perfect Choice

Forget about the regular PCs and laptops, even the MacBooks could not survive the Chromebook onslaught. Such is the magic of these Google machines. Like Android, Chromebooks have plenty of options. One finds some really interesting choices in the range of Chromebooks. Although these Google laptops have recently ventured into the Indian market, they seem to have already made their mark in the international market

DIKSHA GUPTA

Chromebooks are low-cost laptops that offer a rather refreshing and enjoyable experience. Google is promoting its Chromebooks as "a new type of computer with everything built-in. For everyone. Starting \$199." Chromebooks are definitely the latest breed of laptops and are here to stay. These low-cost laptops were first announced in 2010 and started emerging in 2011 as the web-centric alternatives to the traditional laptops.



What is a Chromebook

Google defines Chromebooks as "a new type of computer designed to help you get things done faster and easier. They run Chrome OS, an operating

system that has multiple layers of security, cloud storage and the most popular Google products built-in." Chrome OS has the Linux kernel as its base and the Google Chrome Web browser serves as the interface which allows users to access files and run Chrome Web apps.

Chromebooks can be used best only when connected to the Internet, unlike the traditional laptops. And you do not have to work on traditional software if you are a Chromebook user. For instance, for anything to be done on Microsoft office, Chromebook users resort to Google Docs and save them in Google Drive.

It is not that you cannot work on a Chromebook offline, you just need to pick the right apps for that. Google highlights the apps that can be used offline from the Chrome Web Store itself.

Advantages of buying a Chromebook

Chromebooks are for those looking for a basic, trendy computer, while saving on their credit card bills. There are many advantages of buying a Chromebook.

Number one and really the most important one is its cost effectiveness. Chromebooks are super cheap as compared to a Windows laptop. They are available for as low as ₹22,999. At this price, you can find a Windows laptop but surely of a very low configuration as compared to the svelte MacBook Air

SOME CHROMEBOOKS TO CHOOSE FROM

Acer C720



Price: Starting at ₹22,999

- > 29.464cm (11.6-inch) 1366 x 768 display, 16:9 aspect ratio
- > 19mm thin - 2.76lbs/1.25kg
- > Up to 8.5 hours of active use
- > New Intel Processor
- > 100GB Google Drive Cloud Storage2 with 16GB Solid State Drive
- > Built-in dual-band Wi-Fi 802.11 a/b/g/n, 3G modem (opt)
- > VGA camera
- > 1 x USB 3.0, 1 x USB 2.0
- > Full-size HDMI Port
- > Bluetooth 4.0 compatible

HP Chromebook 14



Price: Starting at ₹26,990

- > 35.56cm (14-inch), 200-nit display with 16:9 aspect ratio
- > 20mm thin - 4.08lbs/1.85kg
- > Up to 9.5 hours of active use
- > New Intel Processor
- > 100GB Google Drive Cloud Storage2 with 16GB Solid State Drive
- > Built-in dual-band Wi-Fi 802.11 a/b/g/n, 3G modem (opt)
- > HP TrueVision HD webcam
- > 2 x USB 3.0, 1 x USB 2.0
- > Full-size HDMI port
- > Bluetooth 4.0 compatible

Samsung Chromebook



Price: Starting at ₹26,990

- > 29.464cm (11.6-inch) (1366x768) display
- > 17.5mm thin - 1.1kg
- > Over 6.5 hours of battery
- > Samsung Exynos 5 dual processor
- > 100GB Google Drive Cloud Storage2 with 16GB Solid State Drive
- > Built-in dual-band Wi-Fi 802.11 a/b/g/n, 3G modem (opt)
- > VGA camera
- > 1 x USB 3.0, 1 x USB 2.0
- > HDMI port
- > Bluetooth 3.0 compatible